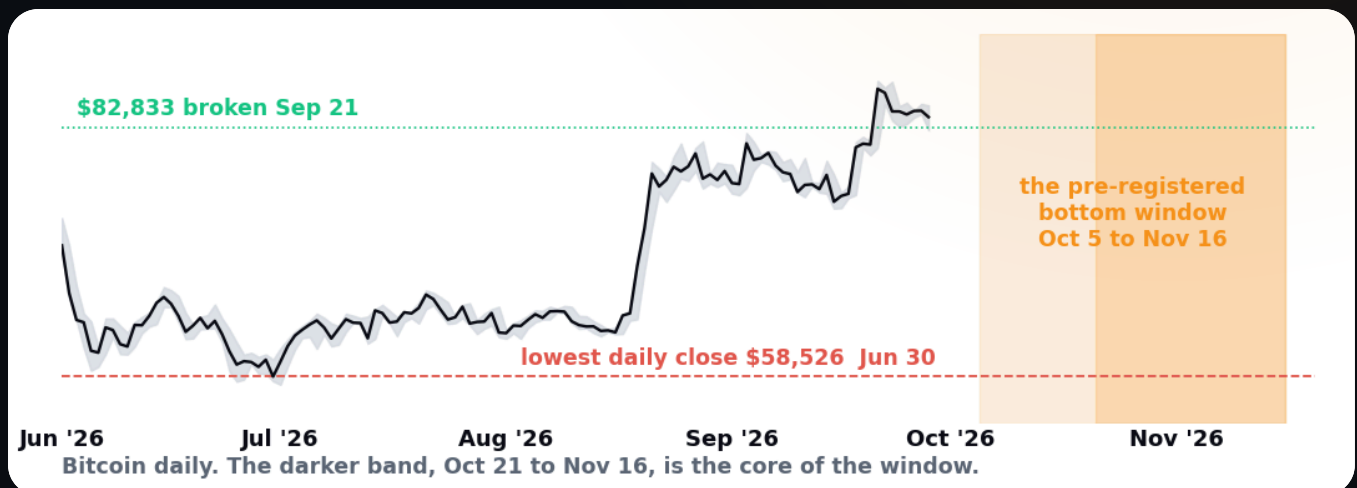


THE OCTOBER 2026 PLAYBOOK

In July I published a paper that pre-registered the Bitcoin cycle bottom for 5 October to 16 November 2026. In September Bitcoin broke its last lower high. October is where those two collide.

Where the window came from, the block clock, the rule that says when the call has failed, the two ways October goes, and every date and level to watch.



Oct 5

the pre-registered bottom window opens

\$58,526

the lowest daily close, the line for the clock

969,027

block height on 28 Sep, already inside the band

Educational, not financial advice. The window is a written, dated prediction from a published paper. This guide explains how it will be graded, including the ways it can fail.



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THE WINDOW

WHERE OCTOBER 5 TO NOVEMBER 16 CAME FROM



days from each cycle's all-time high to its bear-market low, on the wicks.

"Bitcoin Runs on a Clock" measures Bitcoin's cycle against the halving, the scheduled cut in new supply every 210,000 blocks. The paper's main result is about tops, which have landed at the same point in the halving cycle three times in a row. From the same framework it registered two predictions in advance, before either could be seen, and the first is the 2026 bottom.

ANCHOR	WINDOW	WHAT IT MEASURES
After the top	5 Oct to 16 Nov 2026	364 to 406 days after the 6 Oct 2025 top
Before the next halving	21 Oct to 19 Nov 2026	where past bottoms clustered, counted back from the next halving
Core, both anchors	21 Oct to 16 Nov 2026	the overlap, the robust core of the call

Manuscript section 8.2. The next-halving anchor is provisional because the halving's date drifts.

The paper itself calls the bottom the weaker of its two predictions, because a bear lasting about a year is partly just what big drawdowns do. A hit would be modest evidence for the clock. A miss would be modest evidence against it.

THE SAME WINDOW, IN BLOCKS

The halving is an exact number of blocks, not an exact number of days. So the paper also logged the bottom window as a block-height band, computed on 21 July 2026 before the window opened. It runs from block 968,910 to block 973,934, which is 128,910 to 133,934 blocks after the April 2024 halving at block 840,000.

BLOCK CLOCK	VALUE
Band start	968,910
Band end	973,934
Height on 28 Sep 2026	969,027
Blocks left in the band	about 4,900
At about 144 blocks a day	about 34 days, into early November

Height from mempool.space on 28 September 2026. Block times vary, so the calendar end of the band moves.

Blocks have been arriving faster than the ten-minute average, so the block window opened in late September, about a week before the calendar one. By the block clock the window is already open.

THE TEST

HOW THE CALL FAILS

The paper wrote its own failure condition in advance. The bottom call is contradicted if the cycle's lowest daily close lands more than about 90 days from the 21 October to 16 November core. On the early side, that means a cycle low before roughly 23 July 2026.

FACT	VALUE
All-time high	6 Oct 2025, \$126,272 (wick)
Lowest daily close since	30 Jun 2026, \$58,526
Lowest wick since	1 Jul 2026, \$57,735
Days from the lowest close to the core	113
Tolerance written in the paper	about 90

Bitstamp BTC/USD. The paper's test uses daily closes.

STATED PLAINLY

If 30 June 2026 was the cycle bottom, the pre-registered bottom call missed. The only way it holds is a new daily close under \$58,526 inside the window.

THE TWO PATHS

OCTOBER GOES ONE OF TWO WAYS

Path one, the clock was right. Bitcoin makes a new daily close under \$58,526 between 5 October and 16 November. The September break of \$82,833 was a trap, the bear made its final low on schedule, and the clock passes its first real-time test.

Path two, the market bottomed early. No new low. The bear ended at about day 268 instead of day 364 to 406, the September break was the real turn, and the clock's bottom call misses by more than its tolerance. The top prediction for 2029 would still stand, but the clock would need to explain a bear that was both shallower and shorter than every one before it.

What the September studies say. The calendar sides with path one. The 2014, 2018 and 2022 bears had all fallen 71% to 75% by day 268 and all went lower later, with final lows on day 410, 363 and 376. The structure sides with path two. Closes above the last lower high that also held the weekly close became traps 2 times in 13, and this one held. Early breaks, within 90 days of the low, were traps 3 times in 7.

THE CALENDAR

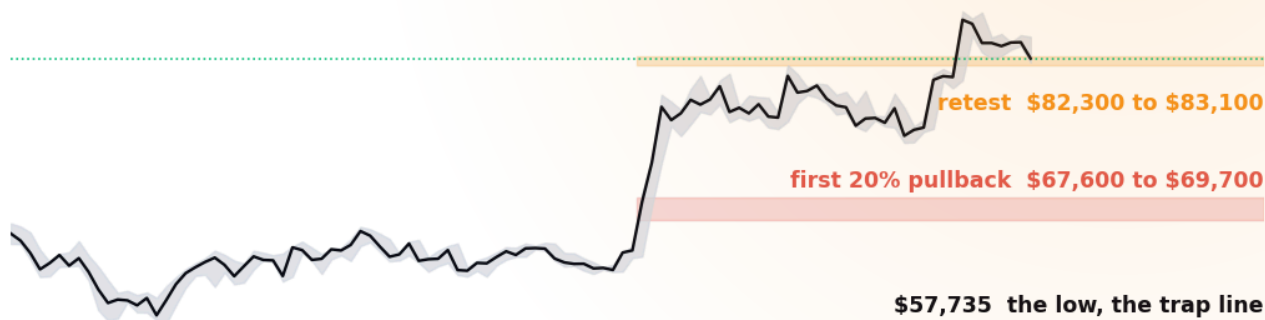
EVERY OCTOBER DATE

DATE	WHAT	WHY IT MATTERS
Late Sep	Block band opens	block 968,910, the block-clock start of the window
Oct 4	Day 363 of the bear	the earliest final low of the last three bears
Oct 5	Calendar window opens	364 days after the top
Oct 16	Fed decision graded	the 16 Sep hike against its bucket, 30 days on
Oct 21	Core of the window starts	both anchors overlap from here to 16 Nov
Oct 24	Bart finish line	\$66,700, the August Bart case
Oct 28	Fed decision	2pm ET, with a press conference and no dot plot
Early Nov	Block band closes	block 973,934, depending on block times
Nov 16	Calendar window closes	406 days after the top

Fed date from the published 2026 FOMC meeting schedule.

THE LEVELS

EVERY LEVEL FOR OCTOBER



Jul '26 Aug '26 Sep '26 Oct '26
Bitcoin daily. Every level from this month's studies. The dotted line is \$82,833.

LEVEL	WHAT IT IS
\$87,374	the September high after the break
\$82,833	the last lower high, broken on 21 Sep, weekly close above on 27 Sep
\$82,300 to \$83,100	the retest zone of the breakout
\$67,600 to \$69,700	a normal first pullback of 20% to 23%
\$58,526	the lowest daily close, the line for the clock
\$57,735	the lowest wick

A pullback that holds above \$58,526 is a miss for the clock.

HOW OCTOBER GETS SCORED

The clock. On 16 November the window closes. If there is a daily close under \$58,526 between 5 October and 16 November, the bottom call hit. If not, it missed, and the miss is published as a miss.

The Fed. On 16 October the September hike is graded against the surprise buckets in The Fed Decision Study. **The Bart.** On 24 October the August Bart case is graded against \$66,700.

The limits. Three past bottoms are three data points, and the paper says so. The bear-duration part of the call is partly what any big drawdown does. And one real-time test does not prove or break a framework. It is the first piece of a forecasting record, which is the thing the paper said it lacked.

Data pinned 28 September 2026. Window and block band from "Bitcoin Runs on a Clock", section 8.2. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily bars. Block height from mempool.space. Scripts: OctPlaybook/op_charts.py, Outcomes/oc_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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